GENERAL SECURITY - ACCEPTABLE USE

WyIT 3001

PURPOSE: The purpose of this policy is to outline the expectations of all Executive Branch agencies, boards, and commissions regarding the acceptable use of IT resources by authorized users and to establish the parameters for the use of IT resources. Additionally, this policy ensures the acceptable use of information systems, electronic and computing devices, and network resources to conduct State business, whether owned or leased by the State, its agencies, or a third party (aka Affiliates). All employees, contractors, vendors, and/or affiliates of the State of Wyoming are responsible for exercising good judgment regarding the appropriate use of information systems, electronic devices, and network resources. The State requires that these systems be used responsibly and in compliance with all State legislation and policies.

I. APPLICABILITY

This policy applies to all Executive Branch agencies, boards, and commissions staff (collectively referred to as “agencies”). Additionally, this policy is also applicable to consultants, affiliates, and temporary employees.

II. DEFINITIONS

All definitions for this policy are located in the Policy Dictionary.

III. EXCEPTIONS

Any exceptions provided to the following policy must abide by the WyIT - 3002 - Security Exception Request policy.

IV. ACCEPTABLE USE OF ASSETS

- Assets include, but are not limited to, physical equipment, such as desktop computers, servers, printers, laptops, telephones, mobile devices, and removable media (such as USB flash drives), as well as systems and services, such as the organizational network, internet, and voicemail. Organizational data is also an asset. All devices and systems are property of the State, and all use must be in accordance with its policies, standards, and guidelines.

    - The CIO allows limited use of the network, systems, and devices for personal reasons, but personal use must not be abused. Occasional and incidental personal use is permitted, provided that it is limited to the following considerations:
        - Is otherwise consistent with all State policies.
        - Is limited in amount and duration.
        - Does not impede the ability of the individual or other users to fulfill the State's responsibilities and duties, including but not limited to extensive bandwidth, resource, or storage utilization.
        - Is not being utilized during travel that is deemed personal and not work related.

    - Exercising good judgment regarding occasional and incidental personal use is important. The CIO may revoke or limit this privilege at any time.
    - Users shall not access and/or purchase technology, devices, applications, or services that are not formally authorized and approved by the CIO procurement review process.
    - IT assets, such as laptops and mobile devices, are intended to be used only by the people to whom they have been issued. The person to whom the device was issued is ultimately responsible for any actions performed with the device.
    - Users will protect all State assets at all times, keeping them physically and logically secured and under the control of the user, including but not limited to:

        - Ensuring the device is locked (screen/keyboard) when unattended by the authorized user.

    - Access to State systems and devices is controlled through individual

accounts and passwords based on roles and responsibilities assigned.

- All voicemail boxes will be protected with a PIN (personal identification number). PINs must be changed every 60-days to aid in mailbox security. Easy-to-guess or previously used PINs will be blocked by the system. PINs must not be shared with others.
- Removable media, such as USB flash drives, etc., may be used with the following requirements:

    - Information shall only be stored on removable media when required in the performance of the user's role (e.g., USB shared between two employees during a conference).
    - Removable storage devices, including but not limited to USB drives, shall be encrypted.
    - Personally owned mobile devices (e.g., smartphones and tablets) are not permitted to be used as removable media to store or transfer any state-owned data.
    - Any unknown removable media that is found unattended must be turned in to the CIO Service Desk and NOT inserted into any State issued device.
    - End users are to take reasonable measures to secure removable media (e.g., storing it in a secure/locked location when not in use, not sharing it with unauthorized users, etc.).
    - Upon completion of the assigned duties, all data shall be deleted, in accordance with NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 1, Guidelines for Media Sanitization, from the removable media.

V. UNACCEPTABLE USES

The following list is not exhaustive, but is an attempt to provide a framework for activities that constitute unacceptable use. Users, however, may be exempted from one or more of these restrictions during their authorized job responsibilities, after approval from the CIO.

- Unacceptable use includes, but is not limited to, the following:
    - Sharing account passwords, Personal Identification Numbers (PINs), security questions/answers, security tokens (e.g., smartcard, key fob), or similar information or devices used for authentication and authorization to State information assets.
    - Engaging in the subversion of existing security controls (e.g., network,

computer, or device hacking and scanning, password cracking, penetration testing, conducting red team exercises, etc.).

- Purposely introducing malicious programs into the network or server (e.g., malware, viruses, worms, trojan horses, etc.).
- Distributing, transmitting, posting, or storing any electronic communications, material, or correspondence that is threatening, obscene, harassing, pornographic, offensive, defamatory, discriminatory, inflammatory, illegal, or intentionally false or inaccurate.
- Adding or installing personal information technology resources (e.g., wireless access points, software, mobile devices, etc.) to existing State information systems.
- Purposely using, acquiring, reproducing, transmitting, or distributing any information, software, or other electronic materials (e.g., movies, music) in violation of applicable copyright, trademark, intellectual property laws, and contractual agreements.
- Installing, downloading, or running software that has not been approved by the CIO.
- Using an organization's IT resources to circulate unauthorized solicitations or advertisements for non-organizational purposes, including religious, political, or not-for-profit organizations.
- Providing unauthorized affiliates access to the State's technology resources that have not been designated as "guest."
- Using State technology, information, or resources for commercial or personal purposes, in support of "for-profit" activities, or in support of other outside employment or business activity (e.g., consulting for pay, business transactions).
- Propagating chain letters, fraudulent mass mailings, spam, or other types of undesirable and unwanted email content using organizational IT resources.

VI. ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATION AND INTERNET USE

The use of the State's communication and internet systems and services (including but not limited to email, instant messaging, voicemail, forums, and social media) is provided in order to perform regular job duties. The use is a privilege and must be used with respect, common sense, and in accordance with the following requirements:

- The email systems and other messaging services used at the State are owned by the State and are, therefore, its property. This gives the State the right to monitor any and all email traffic passing through its email system. This monitoring may include, viewing of emails during the course of investigating cybersecurity incidents related to email abuse, phishing or hacking, inadvertent reading by IT staff during the normal course of managing the email system, review by human resources and legal team during the email discovery phase of litigation, and observation by management in cases of suspected abuse or employee inefficiency.
- The State often delivers official communications via email. Employees of the State with email accounts are expected to check their email consistently to be aware of important State announcements and updates, and for fulfilling business and role-oriented tasks.
- Electronic communication and the internet must not be used for illegal or unlawful purposes, including, but not limited to, copyright infringement, obscenity, libel, slander, fraud, defamation, plagiarism, harassment (including offensive and/or insulting content), discrimination, intimidation, forgery, impersonation, illegal gambling, soliciting for illegal pyramid schemes, and computer tampering (e.g. spreading computer viruses).
- State communication platforms and the internet are not to be used for purposes that could reasonably be expected to strain storage or bandwidth (e.g., emailing large attachments instead of pointing to a location on a shared drive). Individual use of resources will not interfere with others' use of State email systems and services.
- Users are prohibited from using accounts that do not belong to them and are prohibited from using platforms to impersonate others.
- Users are not to give the impression that they are representing or providing opinions on behalf of the State unless otherwise authorized.
- Users shall not open message attachments or click on hyperlinks sent from unknown or unsigned sources through any platform (email, instant message, social media, etc.). Attachments/links are the primary source of malware and social engineering and shall be treated with utmost caution.
- Any allegations of misuse shall be promptly reported to the CIO Service Desk. If you receive an offensive or suspicious email, do not forward, delete, or reply to the message. Instead, report it directly to the CIO Service Desk.
- Email users are responsible for mailbox management, including organization and cleaning. If a user subscribes to a mailing list, they must be aware of how to unsubscribe from the list and are responsible for doing so in the event that their

current email address changes.

- Archival and backup copies of email messages exist, despite end-user deletion, in compliance with the State of Wyoming Records Retention Policy.
- Email access will be terminated when the employee or affiliate terminates their association with the State. The State is under no obligation to store or forward the contents of an individual's email inbox/outbox after the term of their employment has ceased.
- Users shall not send sensitive information that is not appropriately protected (encrypted). Appropriate means of protection include but are not limited to Google Drive or sending encrypted email standards.
- Users shall take extra precautions when transmitting State, stakeholder, and/or other regulated information via electronic communications. Sensitive material shall be marked and encrypted appropriately. Keep in mind that all email messages sent outside of the State become the property of the receiver.
- Users are not permitted to automatically forward emails received by their State account to a non-state-owned email address or other messaging system.
- Email users are expected to remember that emails sent from the State's email accounts reflect on the State. Please comply with normal standards of professional and personal courtesy and conduct.
- Users are permitted to remotely access the state network while offsite. All users who remotely access State IT resources shall ensure compliance with the Remote Access policy (WyIT-3017 - Remote Access).

VII. SOCIAL MEDIA

State social media accounts are permitted to be used for business purposes only. These purposes include building a positive brand image, providing stakeholder support, monitoring public opinion, and professional networking. The following requirements are imposed for the appropriate use of social media:

- Access to social media will be open to staff who have received approval from their agency director. Approval will be provided given a legitimate business function.
- All actions and communications through social media must adhere to all previously defined acceptable uses of electronic communications.
- The use of personal social media accounts and user IDs for State use is prohibited.
- The use of State social media user IDs for personal use is prohibited.

VIII. DATA SECURITY

Maintaining the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of organizational data is paramount to the security and success of the organization. The following requirements are defined to keep data secure and handled appropriately:

- All organizational data is owned by the State, and all users are responsible for appropriately respecting and protecting all data.
- Users must keep all data secure by taking sensible precautions and following the requirements defined in the WyIT - 2001 Information Classification policy and the data-handling requirements defined in the WyIT - S - 2001 Information Classification Standard. This standard outlines the requirements for creating, using, storing, transmitting, archiving, and destroying data.
- Data must be classified based on sensitivity, as defined in the WyIT - 2001 Information Classification policy. Data must be classified as Public, Internal, or Confidential. Data at each classification level must be safeguarded and handled appropriately in accordance with the WyIT - S - 2001 Information Classification Standard.
- Users may not view, copy, alter, or destroy data, software, documentation, or data communications belonging to the State or another individual without authorized permission.
- Users will only access data provided to them for duties in connection with their employment or engagement and in accordance with their terms and conditions of employment or equivalent.
- Extraction, manipulation, and reporting of State data must be done for business purposes only.
- Personal use of organizational data, including derived data, in any format and at any location, is prohibited.
- Users will follow all State sanctioned data removal procedures to permanently erase data from devices once its use is no longer required, as defined in WyIT - S - 2001 Information Classification Standard. Data must be retained for the length of time defined in accordance with the State of Wyoming Archivist Retention and Disposition requirements.

IX. MOBILE DEVICE USE

- Personal mobile devices are not authorized to be accessed or used for state business.
- It is the responsibility of any employee who uses state-issued mobile device(s) to ensure that all security protocols normally used in the management of data on conventional storage infrastructure are also applied. It is imperative that any mobile device that is used to conduct State business be used appropriately, responsibly, and ethically.
- The CIO reserves the right to refuse, by physical and non-physical means, the ability to connect mobile devices to State and state-connected infrastructure. The CIO will engage in such action if such equipment is being used in a way that puts the State's systems, data, users, and clients at risk.
- All authorized mobile devices used for access to State systems and/or data (such as email) must be protected by strong access control (e.g., complex passwords and multi-factor authentication). Employees must never disclose their passwords to anyone, even to family members, if work is conducted from a mobile device.
- All users of mobile devices must employ reasonable physical security measures. All users are expected to secure all such devices whether or not they are actually in use and/or being carried.
- No non-state computers are authorized to synchronize or back up data of state-issued mobile devices.
- Sensitive data and passwords must not be stored, without using the State authorized encryption solution, on the state-owned mobile devices.
- In the event of a lost or stolen State mobile device, it is incumbent on the user to report the incident to the CIO Service Desk immediately.
- Mobile devices may only access the State network and data through the internet using the authorized secure VPN connection. The VPN portal web address will be provided to users as required. Smart mobile devices such as smartphones, tablets, and laptops will access the State network and data using mobile VPN software installed on the device by the CIO.

X. PASSWORD STANDARDS

- Access to State systems and devices is controlled through individual accounts and passwords. The following requirements are in place to protect those passwords and access to sensitive data and systems:

    - Users will not share account or password information with another person.
    - Accounts are to be used only by the assigned user of the account and only for authorized purposes.
    - Attempting to obtain another user's account password is strictly prohibited.
- A user must contact the CIO Service Desk to obtain a password reset if they have reason to believe any unauthorized person has learned their password. Users must take all necessary precautions to prevent unauthorized access to State resources, services, and data.
- Users with passwords that have been identified as compromised will be automatically reset.
- Users must not use State system passwords for non-state accounts (i.e. personal banking, social media, etc). In the event that non-state account(s) are compromised, it could leave State system accounts compromised as well.
- Password complexity will be enforced by IT through system-enforced policies to ensure strong passwords and proper password hygiene:
    - Passwords will expire every 60 days, and users will be forced to change them. Users are encouraged to reset their passwords prior to the expiration date to minimize any interruption to network access.
    - A minimum lifespan of 1-day is enforced to prevent too frequent password changes.
    - The previous 24 passwords cannot be reused.
    - Password complexity requirements enforce the use of a minimum of uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters. It needs to be 14 characters long.
    - Upon 3 failed login attempts, accounts will be locked. Accounts can be unlocked by waiting for the 60 minutes to elapse or contacting the Service Desk.

XI. INCIDENT RESPONSE AND REPORTING

The State has an incident response program for efficient remediation of information security incidents. Employees are expected to comply with the following requirements in order to ensure effective and efficient incident remediation:

- Users must report any suspected security incident to the CIO service desk, including but not limited to lost/stolen equipment, suspected malware infection, compromised credentials, and any other possible compromises of State systems and/or data.

- Users must cooperate with incident response processes, such as forfeiting their equipment to the CIO for investigation if it is potentially compromised.

XII. SECURITY AWARENESS AND TRAINING

Human error and negligence are common sources of security issues. The State takes a proactive approach by requiring security awareness and training:

- During onboarding, all users will be required to undergo information security awareness and training. Upon completion, users will be required to sign a declaration that they have completed training, understand the requirements and specific procedures taught, and intend to abide by the policies and procedures provided.
- Users must complete ongoing security awareness and training as assigned. Employees will be kept up to date on new improvements and emerging threats.

REFERENCES:

- NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 1. Guidelines for Media Sanitization
- WyIT - 2001 Information Classification Policy
- WyIT - 2001-S Information Classification Standard
- WyIT 3001-S Sending Encrypted Email Standard
- State of Wyoming Records Retention Schedules

DOCUMENT HISTORY

ORIGINAL SUBMISSION				
SUBMITTED ON	**SUBMITTED BY**	**APPROVED BY**	**APPROVED BY DATE(S)**	**EFFECTIVE DATE**
June 2024	ETS Governance, Risk and Compliance	Public Comment Period	05/10/2024 - 05/24/2024	June 2024

REVISIONS			
REVISION DATE	**REVISED BY**	**SUMMARY OF REVISIONS**	**LAST APPROVED BY**
March 2025	ETS Governance, Risk and Compliance	- Updated Links	**OPTIONS** June 2024

REVIEWS		
LAST REVIEW DATE	**LAST REVIEWED BY**	**NEXT REVIEW DATE**